

Start here. Plan your crop.

The front brings your crop's essentials together.

Read your own crop's figures; this carrot sheet is an example.

Check the essentials

Quick Facts puts the useful numbers together. Check seed depth and both kinds of spacing.



Depth



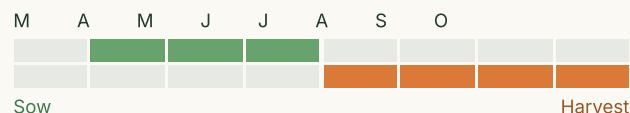
Rows



Plants

Find your growing window

Green shows sowing; orange shows harvest. Use the months as a guide to local conditions.



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ROOT CROPS

CARROT

SUM / AUT

12 WEEKS

DIFFICULTY
NOT DIFFICULT

Freshly pulled, they're a different vegetable entirely.

Carrots are one of the tastiest vegetables to pull fresh from the garden, with a sweetness and earthy flavour that is hard to match from shop-bought roots. They are also one of the more awkward crops to establish well: germination can be slow, seedlings are vulnerable to slugs, and the roots need deep, fine, stone-free soil if they are to grow straight and tender. Once growing, however, carrots are very rewarding, especially if sown in short successions so that roots can be lifted from early summer into autumn.

QUICK FACTS

SOW

Apr - Jun

HARVEST

Aug - Oct

GERMINATION

17 days

DEPTH

1.3 cm

ROW SPACING

15 cm

PLANT SPACING

Thin to 5-8 cm apart

YIELD (3 M ROW)

3.6 kg

READY IN

12 weeks

CORE NEEDS

1 = LOW 5 = HIGH

SUN

4/5

WATER

3/5

NUTRITION

2/5

KEY RISKS

CARROT FLY
 Tell-tale signs on carrots are reddish leaves which wilt in sunny weather and later turn yellow.

OLD SEED / POOR GERMINATION
 Parsnip seed loses viability quickly.

FANGING
 Fanging is usually caused by adding manure or compost to the soil shortly before seed sowing.

SMALL ROOTS
 Aphids and virus will stunt growth and reduce yield, but even in the absence of pests and diseases many gardeners produce disappointingly small carrots.

SOWING & HARVEST CALENDAR

	J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
SOW												
HARVEST												

RECOMMENDED VARIETIES

TYPE	VARIETY	NOTES
Intermediate-Rooted	Chantenay Red Cored	Most popular maincrop; stump-rooted, deep orange flesh, smooth skin.
Short-Rooted	Early French Frame	A round carrot - an excellent choice for shallow soils.
	Early Scarlet Horn	A good carrot of the Nantes type which is recommended for sowing under clothes in early March.

KEY RISKS

Know what to watch for

Scan the risks before you start. Turn over for symptoms and control advice.

Read the five-block scale

Core Needs rates sun, water and nutrition. More filled blocks mean a greater need.

1 = low need				5 = high need

Choose a variety

Compare the notes for flavour, season or growing conditions that suit your plot.

VARIETY

What makes it useful →

VEGETABLE CHEAT SHEETS

HOW TO USE · 1 / 2

Turn over. Get growing.

Planting, care and picking - explained at a glance.

Use the practical steps while you work.

Follow the planting steps

Read the numbered pictures in order. Check the depth and spacing labels below them.



Keep it growing

Use Looking After the Crop for routine care as plants develop.



Water



Weed

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ROOT CROPS

CARROT

Carrots are hard to please.
The ideal soil is deep, fertile, stone-free and sandy.

Carrots are light feeders and don't need manure.
They prefer to follow a crop which was manured the previous year.

Keep weeds down while the seedlings are small.
Weeds can easily smother them.



SOIL & PREPARATION

- 1 Use deep, fertile, sandy, stone-free soil; choose short roots for heavy or stony ground.
- 2 Follow a manured crop, avoid fresh manure, lime acid soil and prepare a fine seedbed.

LOOKING AFTER THE CROP

- 1 Thin to 2-3 in. in damp weather, firm soil and destroy thinnings.
- 2 Weed carefully while seedlings are small and avoid disturbing mature roots.
- 3 Water deeply and evenly; sudden soaking after drought can split roots.

SOWING & PLANTING

- 1 **Sow thinly**

Sow direct, very thinly, in shallow drills.
- 2 **Cover lightly**

Cover lightly with fine soil or compost.
- 3 **Thin later**

Thin young seedlings to the final spacing below.

Seed depth: 1.3 cm
Rows: 15 cm
Final plants: Thin to 5-8 cm apart

- Mix seed with sand or fine peat to sow thinly and see the row clearly.
- Sow pelleted seed about 1 in. apart for easier spacing.
- Wait for warmer soil if early conditions are cold and wet.

HARVESTING

- Lift from one row end, easing roots with a fork to limit carrot-fly scent.
- Lift maincrops by October or before frost, splitting or pest damage.

PESTS & DISEASES

PEST / DISEASE	SIGNS	CONTROL
Carrot Fly	Tunnelled roots	Cover with fine mesh, sow thinly and destroy thinnings. Avoid bruising roots.
Old Seed / Poor Germination	Parsnip seed loses viability quickly.	Resow with fresh seed and keep the drill moist until seedlings emerge.
Fangings	Forked roots	Remove stones, improve soil deeply and avoid fresh manure.
Small Roots	Aphids and virus will stunt growth and reduce yield, but even in the absence of pests and diseases many gardeners produce disappointingly small carrots.	Improve soil deeply and feed slow plants with a liquid or foliar feed.
Splitting	Split roots	Water deeply and regularly, mulch in drought and use split roots promptly.

FINAL TIPS



Thin to 2-3 in. in damp weather, firm soil and destroy thinnings.



Weed carefully while seedlings are small and avoid disturbing mature roots.



Water deeply and evenly; sudden soaking after drought can split roots.

Pick at the right moment

Harvesting explains when and how to pick. Look at the plants as well as the calendar.



Ready to pick

Match signs to action

Find a likely problem in the table, compare its signs, then read the suggested response.

SIGNS

→

CONTROL